

# Anxiety Coping Skills Cards

Cut along the lines — keep these cards in your wallet, journal, or phone case

## Deep Breathing

Breathe in for 4 counts, hold for 4, out for 6. Repeat 5 times.  
Focus only on your breath.

## Progressive Muscle Relaxation

Tense each muscle group for 5 seconds, then release. Start from toes, work up to face.

## Grounding (5-4-3-2-1)

Name 5 things you see, 4 you touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, 1 you taste.

## Positive Self-Talk

Replace "I can't handle this" with "I've gotten through hard things before. I can do this."

## Mindful Observation

Pick one object. Study it for 60 seconds: color, texture, shape, weight. Stay curious.

## Body Scan

Close your eyes. Slowly scan from head to toes, noticing tension. Breathe into tight areas.

## Safe Place Visualization

Picture your safe place in detail: sights, sounds, smells, temperature. Stay there for 2 minutes.

## Thought Challenging

Ask: "Is this thought a fact or a feeling? What would I tell a friend? What's the evidence?"

# Anxiety Coping Skills Cards (cont.)

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## Physical Movement

Walk, stretch, dance, or do 10 jumping jacks. Movement releases anxious energy.

## Ice Dive

Hold ice cubes or splash cold water on your face. Cold activates your calming nervous system.

## Journaling

Write for 5 minutes without stopping. Don't edit—just let your thoughts flow onto the page.

## STOP Skill

Stop. Take a breath. Observe what's happening inside and out. Proceed mindfully.

## Counting Backward

Count backward from 100 by 7s (100, 93, 86...). This redirects your thinking brain.

## Compassionate Touch

Place your hand on your heart. Feel its warmth. Say: "This is a moment of suffering. May I be kind to myself."

## Box Breathing

Breathe in 4 counts, hold 4, out 4, hold 4. Trace a square in the air as you go.

## Bilateral Tapping

Cross arms over chest. Alternate tapping left and right shoulders slowly. 10 rounds.